

INTERMEDIATE

Project GPT Exercises Intermediate Level

Exercises 5–8: Decision Rules, Examples, System Prompt & Testing

Based on: How to Build Your Own Project GPT — A Generic Framework

Exercise 5

Step 6 — Decision Rules

Write Decision Rules for Ambiguous Inputs

Step 6 — Decision Rules

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

You run an HR consulting firm. You want a GPT to help screen job applications and flag strong, weak, or borderline candidates based on a job description.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Write at least 6 'If... then...' decision rules your GPT should follow.
2. Include rules for: missing information, weak data, multiple valid options, and unclear tasks.
3. Test your rules against this scenario: 'A candidate's resume has no work experience listed but has 3 relevant certifications.' — what should your GPT do?
4. Explain what would happen without these rules.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Example rules: If experience section is missing, ask 'Is this a fresher application?' If certifications exist but no experience, flag as 'Borderline — needs screening call.' Without rules, GPT might confidently reject a strong candidate or approve a weak one.

Exercise 6

Step 7 — Examples

Create Few-Shot Examples for Your GPT

Step 7 — Examples

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

You manage social media for a fitness brand. You want a GPT to write engaging Instagram captions from a short product or topic brief.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Write 2 good input to output example pairs.
2. Write 1 bad output example (what GPT should NOT produce) and explain why it fails.
3. Add a clarifying note explaining the pattern GPT should learn from your examples.
4. Test: give your examples to a friend — can they predict what a 'good' output looks like for a new input?

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Good example — Input: 'New protein bar launch, flavor: dark chocolate.' Output: 'Your post-workout reward is here. Dark chocolate. Real protein. Zero guilt.' Bad example: 'Introducing our new protein bar in dark chocolate flavor. Buy now.' — too corporate, no personality, no call-to-action.

Exercise 7

Step 8 — System Prompt

Write Your First Complete System Prompt

Step 8 — System Prompt

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

You are a real estate agent. You want a GPT that helps you write personalized property listing descriptions from raw property details.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Combine all 7 components into one system prompt: role, purpose, scope, input format, output format, decision rules, examples.
2. Keep it under 400 words.
3. Highlight which section is which using clear labels.
4. Read it aloud — does it sound like instructions to a professional, or a vague suggestion?

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Your system prompt should be specific enough that two different people using the same prompt would produce very similar outputs. If outputs vary wildly, the prompt is too vague. A good system prompt should produce polished, buyer-focused property descriptions every single time.

Exercise 8

Step 9 — Testing

Stress-Test Your GPT with Messy Inputs

Step 9 — Testing

REAL-WORLD SCENARIO

You have built a GPT to summarize legal contracts. Now test it by deliberately giving it bad, incomplete, or unusual inputs.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Run 5 test cases: (1) a complete input, (2) a very short/vague input, (3) an input in a different format than expected, (4) an input with missing key fields, (5) a completely off-topic input.
2. For each test, document: what you expected, what you got, and what needs fixing.
3. Identify the top 2 failure patterns.
4. Write the instruction changes that would fix those failures.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Common failure patterns: GPT hallucinates missing clauses, or gives a confident summary when data is insufficient. Fix: add a rule — 'If the document is under 100 words, say: insufficient content for summary and ask for the full document.'